



BROWN SNAKE MILLIPEDE
Julus scandinavicus
F: Julidae

A member of a large family of cylindrical millipedes with ring-encased segments, this species occurs in European deciduous woodland, especially on acid soils.



BLACK SNAKE MILLIPEDE
Tachypodoiulus niger
F: Julidae

Unlike its close relatives, this distinctive, white-legged millipede from W. Europe spends much time above ground – even climbing trees and walls.



AMERICAN GIANT MILLIPEDE
Narceus americanus
F: Spirobolidae

This large, Atlantic coast millipede belongs to a family of mainly American, cylindrical millipedes. Like its relatives, it releases noxious chemicals in defence.



AFRICAN GIANT MILLIPEDE
Archispirostreptus gigas
F: Spirostreptidae

One of the largest of all millipedes, this species occurs mainly in tropical E. Africa and is one of many species that release irritating chemicals to defend themselves.

BORING MILLIPEDE
Polyzoniium germanicum
F: Polyzoniidae

This somewhat primitive millipede has a scattered distribution in Europe. It lives in woodland and resembles beech bud scales when coiled.



0.5–1.8 cm
3/16–3/4 in

EASTERN FLAT-BACKED MILLIPEDE
Polydesmus complanatus
F: Polydesmidae

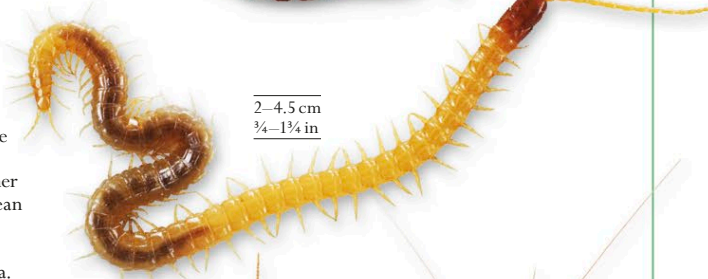
Polydesmids have projections on their exoskeleton that make them look flat-backed. This E. European species is a fast runner.



1.5–6 cm
1/2–2 1/4 in

YELLOW EARTH CENTIPEDE
Geophilus flavus
F: Geophilidae

Eyeless geophilids have more segments (and therefore legs) than other centipedes. This European soil-dweller has been introduced to the Americas and Australia.



2–4.5 cm
3/4–1 1/4 in



4–6 cm
1 1/2–2 1/4 in

TANZANIAN FLAT-BACKED MILLIPEDE
Coromus diaphorus
F: Oxydesmidae

The shiny pitted surface typical of many of the eyeless flat-backed millipedes is especially prominent in this species from tropical Africa.



2–3 cm
3/4–1 1/4 in

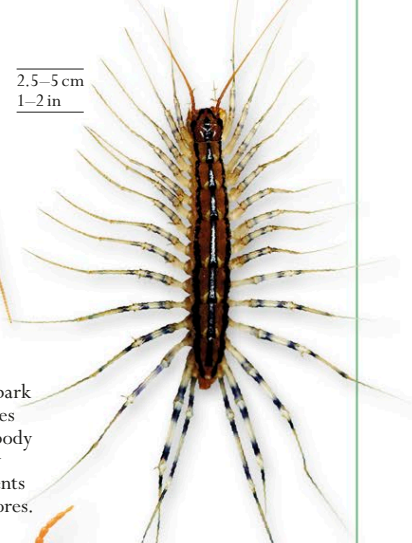
2.5–5 cm
1–2 in

BANDED STONE CENTIPEDE
Lithobius variegatus
F: Lithobiidae

Once thought to be confined to Britain, this centipede is now known in continental Europe, where native populations have unbanded legs.

BROWN STONE CENTIPEDE
Lithobius forficatus
F: Lithobiidae

Found sheltering beneath bark and rock, stone centipedes characteristically have 15 body segments. This globally widespread species frequents forests, gardens, and seashores.



HOUSE CENTIPEDE
Scutigera coleoptrata
F: Scutigerae

An unmistakable centipede, this long-legged animal with compound eyes is one of the fastest invertebrate runners. Native to the Mediterranean region, it has been introduced elsewhere.



20–25 cm
8–10 in

TIGER GIANT CENTIPEDE
Scolopendra hardwicki
F: Scolopendridae

Many of the giant *Scolopendra* centipedes have vibrant warning colours. This Indian species is one of several with a "tiger" pattern.

one pair of legs per body segment



10–15 cm
4–6 in

BLUE-LEGGED CENTIPEDE
Ethmostigmus trigonopodus
F: Scolopendridae

This close relative of the giant *Scolopendra* centipedes is widespread throughout Africa and is one of several species with blue-tinted legs.